RealEstateManager

User Guide Manual

Property, lease and accounting management — complete operating handbook for end users

Properties & Units | Tenants & Contracts | PDC Management | Invoicing & Collections | Double-Entry Accounting | Financial Reporting

Document: RealEstateManager User Guide Manual

Applies to: RealEstateManager web application (ASP.NET Core / SQL Server)

Audience: Property administrators, leasing staff, accountants, system administrators

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CHAPTER 1

About This System

RealEstateManager is a web-based system that manages a real-estate portfolio end to end: the **properties** you own or manage, the **units** inside them, the **tenants** who occupy them, the **lease contracts** that bind the two, and the **complete accounting** that results from all of it.

Its distinguishing characteristic is that operations and accounting are not two separate systems. Every operational action you take — signing a lease, receiving a cheque, issuing an invoice — produces a balanced double-entry journal automatically. You are never asked to write the accounting entry yourself, and the system refuses to save any journal whose debits do not equal its credits.

What the system covers

Area	What it does
Portfolio	Properties (owned or managed), units within each property, occupancy status, standard rents and areas.
Leasing	Tenant register, lease contracts with billing frequency and VAT, automatic generation of the full invoice schedule and the monthly revenue-recognition plan.
Collections	Post-dated cheque (PDC) register with memorandum and clearance postings, customer invoices, customer receipts, security deposits.
Payables	Vendor register, vendor bills with expense categories and recoverable VAT, vendor payments.
Assets & deferrals	Fixed asset register with acquisition-cost accumulation, capitalisation and automatic depreciation schedules; recurring prepayment amortisation.
General ledger	Five-digit chart of accounts, account mapping, opening balances, manual journals, journal inquiry, monthly period close and fiscal year close.
Reporting	Trial Balance, Profit & Loss, Balance Sheet, General Ledger, Tenant Statement.
Administration	Multi-company support, per-user permissions, subscription control, audit logging, user feedback.

Two ownership models

Every property is flagged as either **Owned** or **Managed**, and this single flag changes the accounting for every lease under it:

- **Owned** — the rent is your revenue. Invoiced rent sits in *Advances from Customers* and is released monthly into *Rental Revenue – Owned*.
- **Managed** — the rent belongs to the landlord. Invoiced rent sits in *Due to Landlords*, and only your commission is released into *Management Fee Revenue*.

> **Set the ownership type correctly the first time**
>
> Ownership type is read at the moment an invoice or a revenue-recognition entry is posted. Changing it after transactions exist will not restate what has already been posted.

How to use this manual

- **Menu** ▸ **Screen** notation shows where to find each function, e.g. **Master Data** ▸ **Properties**.
- Green/red **Dr** / **Cr** tables show the exact journal the system posts. These are reference, not data entry — the system writes them for you.
- Chapter 3 is the map. If you read only one chapter, read that one.
- Appendix B collects every automatic journal in one place; Appendix D is the troubleshooting guide.

CHAPTER 2

Getting Started & Signing In

2.1 Signing in

1. Open the application address in your browser. The **Login** page appears.
2. Enter the **Username** and **Password** issued by your administrator.
3. Select **Login**. You land on the **Dashboard**.

If you are a brand-new customer, use **Create New Company** on the login page. This registers a company, creates its first administrator, seeds the full chart of accounts and account mapping, creates the monthly accounting periods, and starts a 15-day trial.

2.2 The navigation bar

Menu	Contains
Setup	Home, Workflow, Subscription, Help, Feedback, Chart of Accounts, Account Mapping, Opening Balances, Revenue Recognition, Recurring Prepayments, Closing; and for system administrators: Companies, Users, Audit Logs, Feedback Review.
Master Data	Properties, Units, Tenants, Leases, Vendors.
Accounts	Customer Invoices, Customer Receipts, PDC Receipts, Vendors, Vendor Bills, Vendor Payments, Security Deposits, Fixed Assets, Manual Journals, Journal Inquiry.
Reports	Trial Balance, General Ledger, Tenant Statement, Profit & Loss, Balance Sheet.

> **Menus adapt to your permissions**
>
> You will only see the menus your account is entitled to. If a colleague can see a menu that you cannot, the difference is a permission, not a fault — see Chapter 30.

2.3 Switching company

If your user account has access to more than one company, a company selector appears at the top right. Choosing a different company reloads the current page in that company's data. Every list, report and balance in the system is filtered to the company you are currently in — you can never see another company's data by accident.

2.4 Changing your password

Select **Password** in the top-right corner, enter your current password, then the new password twice.

2.5 The Dashboard

Setup ▸ **Home** shows the live operating picture: property and unit counts, occupancy rate, collections, outstanding receivables, liabilities and recent tenant activity. Use **Print Dashboard** for a clean printed snapshot.

2.6 Subscription status

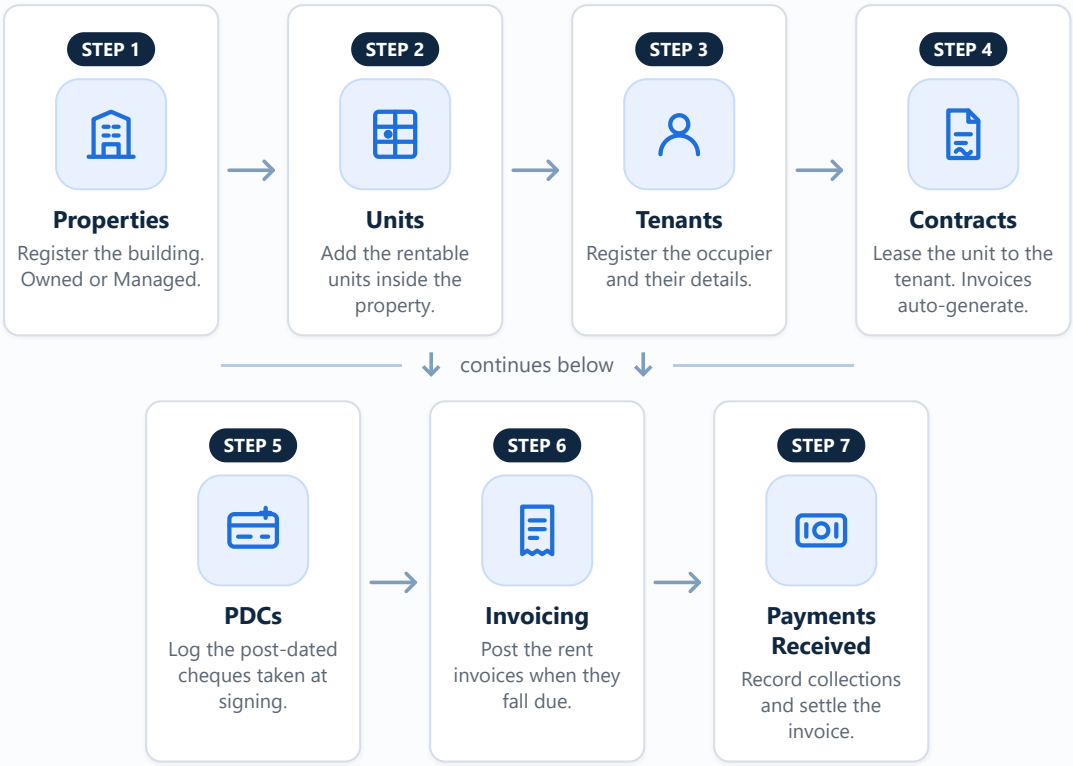
If the company's subscription expires, a red banner appears and the Master Data, Accounts and Reports menus are withdrawn until an activation code is entered under **Setup ▸ Subscription**. Read-only access to Setup remains so that the subscription can be renewed.

CHAPTER 3

The System Workflow

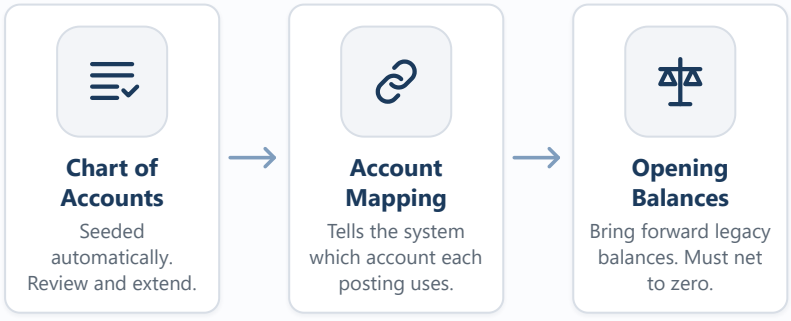
This is the operating map of RealEstateManager. Work left to right: each step depends on the one before it, because the record you create at each stage is selected in the next. The same diagram is available inside the application as a clickable home screen under **Setup ▸ Workflow**.

MAIN OPERATING FLOW — START HERE

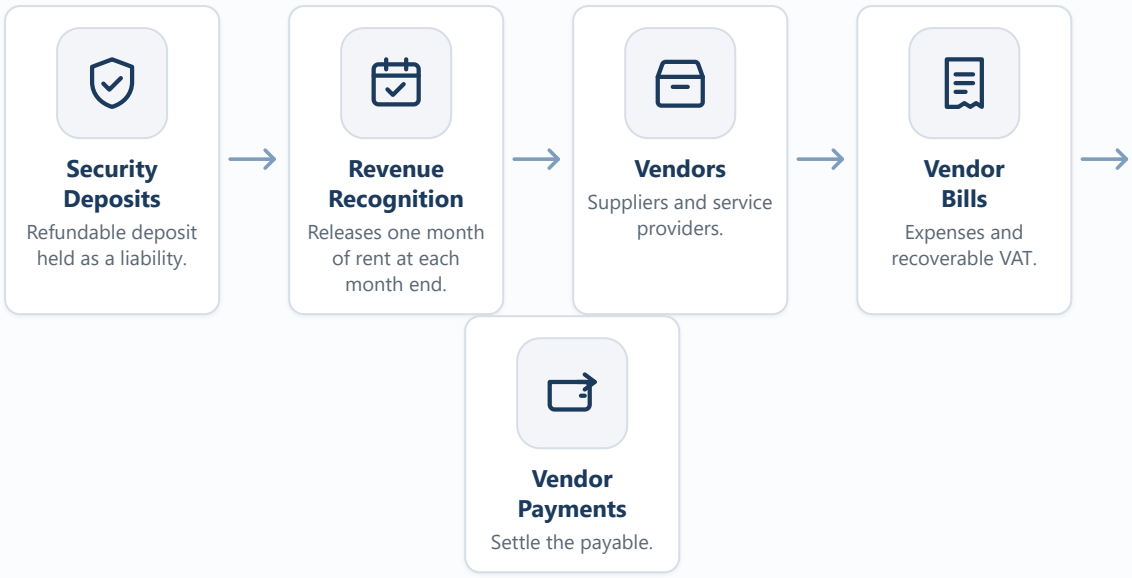


Main operating flow Supporting & period-end activity

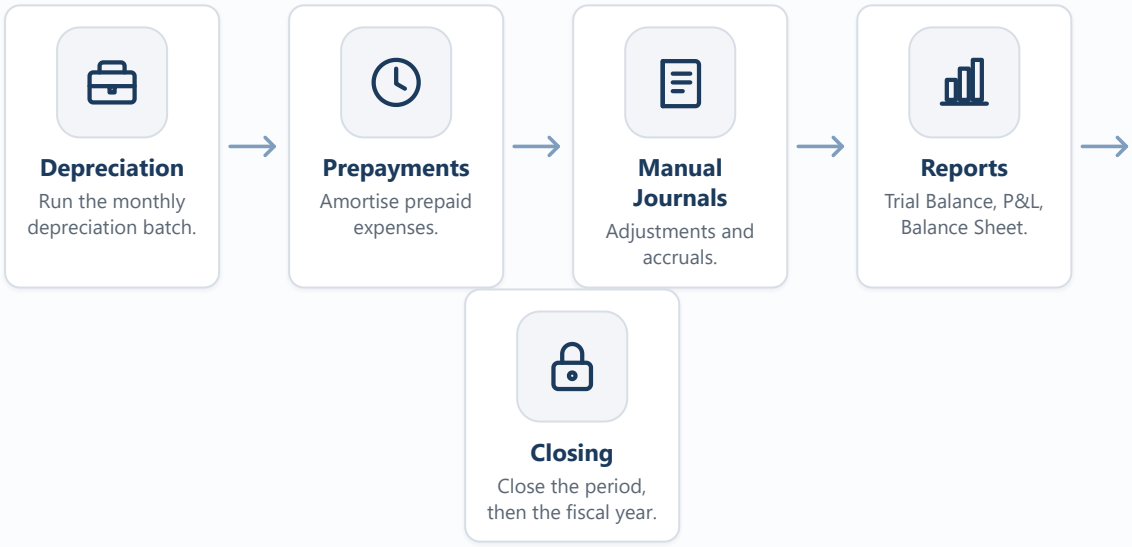
BEFORE YOU START — ONE-TIME COMPANY SETUP



ALONGSIDE THE LEASE — DEPOSITS, REVENUE & PAYABLES



PERIOD END — EVERY MONTH, THEN EVERY YEAR



3.1 What happens at each step

Step	Where	What it creates
1. Properties	Master Data ▸ Properties	The building record and its ownership type. No accounting.
2. Units	Master Data ▸ Units	Rentable units, each starting as *Vacant*. No accounting.
3. Tenants	Master Data ▸ Tenants	The tenant register and any opening receivable balance.
4. Contracts	Master Data ▸ Leases	The lease, **plus** the complete draft invoice schedule **plus** the monthly revenue-recognition plan. The unit becomes *Occupied*.
5. PDCs	Accounts ▸ PDC Receipts	A cheque record and an immediate memorandum journal (PDC On Hand / PDC Contra).
6. Invoicing	Accounts ▸ Customer Invoices	The receivable, the deferred-revenue liability and any VAT payable.
7. Payments	Accounts ▸ Customer Receipts	Cash in, receivable down, invoice status advanced to Partially Paid or Paid.

> **The one rule that makes the flow work**
>
> You cannot skip a step, because each screen selects a record created by the previous screen. There is no unit without a property, no lease without a unit and a tenant, no invoice without a lease, and no receipt without an invoice. If a dropdown is empty, the previous step has not been completed.

3.2 A typical first week

1. **Day 1 — Setup.** Review the Chart of Accounts, confirm Account Mapping, enter Opening Balances and confirm they are balanced.
2. **Day 2 — Portfolio.** Enter every property, then every unit under each property.
3. **Day 3 — People.** Enter tenants (with opening balances if migrating) and vendors.
4. **Day 4 — Contracts.** Enter each live lease. Check the generated invoice schedule after each one.
5. **Day 5 — Cheques.** Log the PDCs held against each lease.
6. **Day 6 — Verify.** Run the Trial Balance and confirm total debit equals total credit.

CHAPTER 4

Chart of Accounts

Setup ▸ Chart of Accounts

The chart of accounts is the backbone of the ledger. A complete five-digit chart is created automatically for every new company, so in most cases you review it rather than build it.

4.1 How the codes are organised

Range	Group	Nature
`10000`	Assets	Debit
`20000`	Liabilities	Credit
`30000`	Equity	Credit
`40000`	Revenue	Credit
`50000`	Direct Expenses	Debit
`60000`	General Expenses	Debit

The six codes above are **group** headers: they organise the tree and cannot be posted to. Detail accounts sit beneath them. The full seeded list is in Appendix A.

4.2 Reading the tree

Accounts are shown as an expandable tree with the account code, name, type, reporting group and current balance. Group rows are shown in bold and have no **Edit** action for posting purposes.

4.3 Adding an account

1. Select **New Account**.
2. Enter a **Code** that fits the range of its parent — a new expense account under General Expenses should begin with `6`.
3. Enter the **Name**, choose the **Account Type** and the **Reporting Group**. These two drive how the account behaves in the reports.
4. Choose the **Parent Account** so the account appears in the right branch of the tree.
5. Leave **Is Postable** ticked for a detail account; untick it (and tick **Is Group**) for a heading.
6. Set the **Opening Balance** only if you are migrating from another system — see Chapter 6.
7. **Save**.

Field	Meaning
Code	Unique five-digit identifier within the company. Determines sort order in every report.
Account Type	Asset, Liability, Equity, Revenue or Expense. Determines the account's natural balance side and whether it appears on the Balance Sheet or the P&L.
Reporting Group	Assets, Liabilities, Equity, Revenue, DirectExpense or GeneralExpense. Controls the section the account is presented in.
Is Control Account	Marks an account whose balance is owned by a sub-ledger (Accounts Receivable, Accounts Payable, Fixed Assets). See the warning below.
Is Group / Is Postable	A group account is a heading and cannot receive journal lines. A postable account can.
Is Active	Untick to retire an account without deleting its history.
Opening Balance	Manual opening balance in natural form: positive means a debit balance for asset/expense accounts and a credit balance for liability/equity/revenue accounts.

> **Control accounts take their opening balance from the sub-ledger**
>
> For Accounts Receivable, Accounts Payable and the fixed-asset accounts, the opening balance is *calculated* from the tenants, vendors and assets beneath them. Typing an opening balance directly onto those accounts has no effect — enter it on the tenant, vendor or asset instead.

4.4 Accounts you should not remove

Several accounts are referenced by the automatic postings. Deactivating one of them will cause the related transaction to fail with a mapping error. Before retiring any account, check Account Mapping (Chapter 5) to confirm it is not in use.

CHAPTER 5

Account Mapping

Setup ▸ Account Mapping

Account Mapping is the bridge between the operational side of the system and the ledger. When you post a customer receipt, the system needs to know *which* account is "cash" and *which* is "accounts receivable". Account Mapping answers exactly that question, once, for the whole company.

Defaults are applied automatically when a company is created, so the system works out of the box. You change a mapping only when your chart of accounts differs from the standard one — for example if you open a dedicated bank account and want receipts to land there instead of in `11100`.

5.1 The mappings

Mapping	Default	Used by
Default Cash	`11100`	Customer receipts, security deposits, PDC clearance, vendor payments
Accounts Receivable	`11200`	Customer invoices, receipts, PDC settlement
VAT Recoverable	`11300`	Vendor bills
PDC On Hand	`11400`	PDC memorandum and clearance
Prepaid Expense (default)	`11500`	Recurring prepayments
Investment Property	`15100`	Property capitalisation
Fixed Asset (default)	`15200`	Fixed asset capitalisation
Accumulated Depreciation (default)	`15300`	Depreciation postings
Fixed Asset Clearing	`15400`	Acquisition cost accumulation before capitalisation
Accounts Payable	`21100`	Vendor bills and payments
Advances from Customers	`21200`	PDC cleared as an advance
Unearned Revenue	`21200`	Owned-property invoicing and revenue release
Tenant Security Deposit Liability	`21300`	Security deposits
VAT Payable	`21400`	Customer invoices
Due to Landlords	`21500`	Managed-property invoicing and commission release
PDC Contra	`21600`	PDC memorandum and its reversal
Retained Earnings – Prior Years	`32100`	Fiscal year closing
Current Year Profit or Loss	`33100`	Fiscal year closing
Rental Revenue – Owned	`41100`	Revenue recognition (owned)
Management Fee Revenue	`42100`	Revenue recognition (managed)
Other Income	`43100`	Miscellaneous income
Direct Expense (default)	`51100`	Vendor bills with a direct expense category
General Expense (default)	`61100`	Vendor bills with a general expense category
Depreciation Expense	`62100`	Depreciation postings
Finance Cost	`63100`	Interest and bank charges

5.2 Changing a mapping

1. Open **Setup** ▸ **Account Mapping**.
2. Choose the replacement account from the dropdown beside the mapping you want to change.
3. **Save**.

Mapping changes are not retrospective

Changing a mapping affects **future** postings only. Journals already posted keep the account they were posted to. If you re-point "Default Cash" to a new bank account mid-year, the earlier balance stays in the old account and must be moved with a manual journal.

If a posting fails with a mapping error

A message such as "*Account mapping for Default Cash is not configured*" means the mapping is empty or points at an account that has been deleted or deactivated. Open Account Mapping, select a valid account, save, and retry the posting.

CHAPTER 6

Opening Balances

Setup ▸ Opening Balances

Opening balances carry your position from a previous system into RealEstateManager. This screen is both the place where you verify them and the single most important control in the whole setup.

6.1 Where each opening balance is entered

Balance	Entered on	Screen
Ordinary GL accounts (cash, equity, loans…)	The account itself	**Setup ▸ Chart of Accounts ▸ Edit**
Accounts Receivable	Each tenant	**Master Data ▸ Tenants ▸ Edit**
Accounts Payable	Each vendor	**Master Data ▸ Vendors ▸ Edit**
Fixed asset cost and accumulated depreciation	Each asset	**Accounts ▸ Fixed Assets**

The control accounts are deliberately not editable directly. Their opening balance is always the sum of the sub-ledger beneath them, which guarantees that the receivables ledger and the AR control account can never drift apart.

6.2 Reading the reconciliation screen

The screen shows three summary cards — **Total Debit Opening Balance**, **Total Credit Opening Balance** and **Net Imbalance (Dr − Cr)** — followed by a per-account table showing, for each account, the manual opening balance, the sub-ledger total, the effective opening balance actually used, and its debit/credit presentation. Beneath the table are the tenant, vendor and fixed-asset detail lists that make up the control account totals.

> **Net Imbalance must be 0.00**
>
> Opening balances are added into the Trial Balance and Balance Sheet as figures, not as a posted journal. Nothing forces the debit side to equal the credit side. If the Net Imbalance card shows any value other than zero, **your Trial Balance will be out of balance by exactly that amount**, and your Balance Sheet will not balance either.
>
> The usual cause is entering asset opening balances (cash, receivables) without entering the matching credit-side opening balance on `31100` Share Capital or `32100` Retained Earnings – Prior Years.

6.3 Procedure for entering opening balances

1. Obtain the closing trial balance from your previous system as at the day before you go live.
2. Enter each **tenant's** outstanding balance on the tenant record. A positive value is an amount owed to you; a negative value is an advance you are holding.
3. Enter each **vendor's** outstanding balance on the vendor record.
4. Enter each **fixed asset's** opening cost and opening accumulated depreciation on the asset.
5. Enter every other balance directly on its **GL account** (cash, bank, loans, share capital, retained earnings).
6. Open **Setup ▸ Opening Balances** and confirm **Net Imbalance = 0.00** with a green *Balanced* badge.

7. Run **Reports** ▸ **Trial Balance** and confirm total debit equals total credit.

> **Balancing figure**
>
> If your legacy trial balance was itself balanced, the figure that makes the Net Imbalance zero is your retained earnings. Post it to `32100` Retained Earnings – Prior Years, not to a suspense account.

CHAPTER 7

Properties

Master Data ▸ Properties · **Workflow step 1**

A property is a building or a site. It is the top of the portfolio hierarchy and the anchor for every unit, lease, invoice and expense beneath it.

7.1 Creating a property

1. Select **New Property**.
2. Enter a short unique **Code** (for example `PROP-001` or `TOWER-A`).
3. Enter the **Name** and **Address**.
4. Choose the **Property Type**: Residential, Commercial, Warehouse or Mixed Use.
5. Choose the **Ownership Type** — *this is the field that drives the accounting*.
6. For a managed property, enter the **Owner Name** and the **Commission Percentage** you earn.
7. Enter the **Asset Value** if you track the property's book value.
8. **Save**.

Field	Meaning
Code	Unique within the company. Appears in every list, report and journal narration.
Property Type	Classification for reporting and filtering. No accounting effect.
Ownership Type	**Owned** — rent is your revenue. **Managed** — rent belongs to the landlord; only commission is your revenue.
Owner Name	The landlord, for managed properties.
Commission Percentage	Your management fee rate on a managed property.
Asset Value	Reference book value. Does not itself post to the ledger.
Is Active	Untick to remove a disposed property from selection lists while keeping its history.

> **Ownership type is decisive**
> Owned and Managed produce entirely different journals for the same invoice. Confirm the ownership type before you create any lease under the property. Review Appendix B if you are unsure which model applies.

7.2 Editing and viewing

The property list shows code, name, type, ownership, unit count and active status. **Edit** opens the same form. The hierarchy view expands a property to reveal its units and their occupancy.

CHAPTER 8

Units

Master Data ▸ Units · **Workflow step 2**

A unit is an individually rentable space inside a property: an apartment, an office, a shop, a warehouse bay. Leases are signed against units, not against properties.

8.1 Creating a unit

1. Select **New Unit**.
2. Choose the **Property** the unit belongs to.
3. Enter the **Unit Number** — unique within that property (e.g. `101`, `G-04`).
4. Enter the **Floor** and the **Usage Type**.
5. Enter the **Area (sq ft)** and the **Standard Annual Rent**.
6. Leave **Status** as *Vacant* — the system changes it automatically.
7. **Save**.

Field	Meaning
Unit Number	Unique within its property. Shown throughout as `PROPERTY/UNIT`.
Area (sq ft)	Used for rent-per-square-foot analysis.
Standard Annual Rent	The asking rent. Offered as a default when a lease is created, and remains editable there.
Status	Vacant · Occupied · Under Maintenance · Reserved.

> **Status is maintained for you**
> Creating an active lease sets the unit to **Occupied** automatically. Set the status manually only for *Under Maintenance* or *Reserved*, which keep the unit out of the leasing flow.

8.2 Occupancy

The dashboard occupancy rate is derived from unit status, so keeping unit status accurate keeps the portfolio reporting accurate. A unit left as *Vacant* while actually leased understates occupancy.

CHAPTER 9

Tenants

Master Data ▸ Tenants · **Workflow step 3**

The tenant register is the receivables sub-ledger. Every tenant's balance rolls up into the `11200` Accounts Receivable control account.

9.1 Creating a tenant

1. Select **New Tenant**.
2. Enter a unique **Code** and the **Full Name** exactly as it should appear on invoices and statements.
3. Enter **Email**, **Phone**, **Nationality**, **ID Number**, **Passport Number** and **Address** as available.
4. Enter the **Opening Balance** only when migrating from another system.
5. **Save**.

Field	Meaning
Code	Unique within the company. Used to sort statements and sub-ledger listings.
Full Name	Legal name. Appears on the lease, invoices, receipts and the tenant statement.
Opening Balance	**Positive** = amount the tenant owes you at go-live. **Negative** = advance you are holding for the tenant. Feeds the AR control account directly.
Is Active	Untick when the tenant leaves. History and statements are retained.

> **Opening balances need a credit counterpart**
> Tenant opening balances increase the debit side of your opening trial balance. Unless you also enter a matching credit-side opening balance (normally retained earnings), the Trial Balance will not balance. Always finish by checking **Setup** ▸ **Opening Balances**.

9.2 Tenant statement

Reports ▸ **Tenant Statement** produces a running account for a single tenant: opening balance, every charge and every payment in date order, and the closing balance. Use it for collection calls and for confirming a balance with a tenant.

CHAPTER 10

Vendors

Master Data ▸ **Vendors** or **Accounts** ▸ **Vendors**

Vendors are your suppliers and service providers — maintenance contractors, utilities, agencies. The vendor register is the payables sub-ledger and rolls up into `21100` Accounts Payable.

10.1 Creating a vendor

1. Select **New Vendor**.
2. Enter a unique **Code** and the vendor **Name**.
3. Enter contact details and, where applicable, the **Tax Registration Number**.
4. Enter the **Opening Balance** only when migrating — positive means you owe the vendor.
5. **Save**.

Vendors are visible to users holding either the Master Data or the Accounting permission, because both the operations team and the accounts team need them.

CHAPTER 11

Lease Contracts

Master Data ▸ Leases · **Workflow step 4**

The lease is the pivot of the whole system. Saving one lease creates, in a single action, the contract, the entire schedule of rent invoices for its term, and the month-by-month revenue-recognition plan.

11.1 Creating a lease

1. Select **New Lease**.
2. Choose the **Unit**. The list shows `PROPERTY/UNIT`.
3. Choose the **Tenant**.
4. Enter a unique **Contract Number**.
5. Enter the **Start Date** and **End Date**.
6. Enter the **Annual Rent** for the full contract year.
7. Choose the **Billing Frequency (Months)** — must divide 12 exactly: 1, 2, 3, 4, 6 or 12.
8. Tick **Is VAT Applicable** and enter the **VAT Rate** if the rent is taxable.
9. Enter the **Security Deposit Amount** agreed in the contract.
10. Add any **Notes**, then **Save**.

11.2 What the system validates

Rule	Message you will see
End date after start date	"End date must be later than start date."
Billing frequency divides 12	"Billing frequency must be 1, 2, 3, 4, 6, or 12."
Contract number unique in the company	"Contract number already exists."
No overlapping active lease on the same unit	"This unit already has an overlapping active lease."

11.3 What is generated automatically

Invoice schedule. The annual rent is divided by the number of invoices per year (12 ÷ billing frequency). One draft invoice is created for each billing date from the start date until the end date, numbered `INV-{contract}-{yyyyMM}`. VAT is calculated per invoice and rounded to two decimals.

Revenue-recognition plan. One planned entry is created for the last day of every calendar month from the start month to the end month, each for one-twelfth of the annual rent. This is what spreads the rent evenly over time regardless of how it was billed or collected.

Unit status. The unit is set to *Occupied* and the lease status to *Active*.

Worked example

Annual rent 175,000, billed quarterly, one-year term starting 1 January:

- 4 invoices of 43,750 each, dated 1 Jan, 1 Apr, 1 Jul, 1 Oct.
- 12 revenue-recognition entries of 14,583.33 each, dated at each month end.

After eight months, 116,666.64 has been recognised as revenue and 58,333.36 remains in *Advances from Customers* as deferred income — which is exactly how the Trial Balance should look.

Editing a lease does not regenerate its schedules

Changing the annual rent, dates or billing frequency of an existing lease updates the contract only. The invoices and revenue-recognition entries already generated are left untouched. If commercial terms change materially, the clean approach is to terminate the lease and raise a new contract, then cancel any unposted invoices from the old one.

11.4 Lease statuses

Status	Meaning
Draft	Being prepared. Not yet operative.
Active	In force. Set automatically on creation. Only active leases appear in the PDC screen.
Terminated	Ended early.
Expired	Ran to its natural end date.
Renewed	Superseded by a successor contract.

CHAPTER 12

PDC Receipts

Accounts ▸ PDC Receipts · **Workflow step 5**

Post-dated cheques are the normal way rent is secured in the region. A PDC is a cheque you hold today that the bank will only honour on a future date. The system tracks it in two stages, each with its own journal, so the cheque is visible in the accounts from the day you receive it without overstating cash.

12.1 Stage one — receiving the cheque

1. Open **Accounts** ▸ **PDC Receipts** and select **New PDC**.
2. Choose the **Lease**. Only active leases are listed.
3. Choose the **Settlement Mode**:
   - **Receivable** — the cheque pays a specific invoice. You must then select the invoice.
   - **Advance** — the cheque is taken before any invoice exists and will sit as a customer advance.
4. If the mode is Receivable, choose the **Invoice**. Only invoices with an outstanding balance appear.
5. Enter the **Cheque Number** (unique in the company) and the **Bank Name**.
6. Enter the **Cheque Date** (the date written on the cheque) and the **Received Date** (the date you took possession).
7. Enter the **Amount** and any **Notes**, then **Save**.

On save, the memorandum journal is posted immediately and the PDC status becomes **Received**:

Account	Debit	Credit
`11400` PDC On Hand	Amount	—
`21600` PDC Contra	—	Amount

This is a memorandum pair: it records custody of the cheque without touching cash or receivables. Its net effect on the balance sheet is nil.

12.2 Stage two — clearing the cheque

When the bank honours the cheque:

1. Find the PDC in the list and select **Clear**.
2. Enter the **Cleared Date**. It cannot be earlier than the received date.
3. Confirm. The status becomes **Cleared**.

Clearance posts a single four-line journal that both reverses the memorandum and records the real money:

Account	Debit	Credit
`21600` PDC Contra (reverse memo)	Amount	—
`11400` PDC On Hand (reverse memo)	—	Amount
`11100` Cash and Cash Equivalents	Amount	—
`11200` Accounts Receivable (Receivable mode) `21200` Advances from Customers (Advance mode)	—	Amount

> **Clearing is self-completing**
>
> If the memorandum was never posted, clearance posts it first. If the linked invoice was still in draft, clearance posts the invoice first so there is a receivable to settle. You do not need to sequence these by hand.

12.3 Validation rules

- Cheque number must be unique within the company.
- Amount must be greater than zero.
- In Receivable mode an invoice is mandatory, it must belong to the selected lease, and the PDC amount cannot exceed the invoice's outstanding balance.
- A PDC cannot be cleared twice.

12.4 PDC statuses

Status	Meaning
Draft	Transient state during creation.
Received	Cheque is in your custody; memorandum journal posted.
Cleared	Bank honoured the cheque; cash recorded and memo reversed.

CHAPTER 13

Customer Invoices

Accounts ▸ Customer Invoices · **Workflow step 6**

Rent invoices are created for you when the lease is saved (Chapter 11). Your job on this screen is to review them and post them when they fall due.

13.1 The invoice list

The list shows the invoice number, date, tenant, unit, subtotal, VAT, total, amount paid and status. Invoices generated from a lease begin in **Draft**: they exist as documents but have not touched the ledger.

13.2 Posting an invoice

1. Locate the invoice in the list.
2. Select **Post**.
3. The journal below is written and the status becomes **Posted**.

Owned property

Account	Debit	Credit
`11200` Accounts Receivable	Total (rent + VAT)	—
`21200` Advances from Customers (unearned revenue)	—	Subtotal
`21400` VAT Payable (only if VAT > 0)	—	VAT

Managed property

Account	Debit	Credit
`11200` Accounts Receivable	Total (rent + VAT)	—
`21500` Due to Landlords	—	Subtotal
`21400` VAT Payable (only if VAT > 0)	—	VAT

> **Why invoicing does not create revenue**
>
> Billing and earning are different events. Issuing a rent invoice creates a receivable and an obligation to provide occupancy — not revenue. Revenue arrives month by month through revenue recognition (Chapter 16). This is what allows the Profit & Loss to show a smooth monthly rent figure even when the tenant is billed annually in advance.

13.3 Invoice statuses

Status	Meaning
Draft	Generated but not posted. No ledger impact. Can be cancelled.
Posted	Journal written; receivable outstanding in full.
PartiallyPaid	Some payment received; a balance remains.
Paid	Fully settled.
Cancelled	Voided. Excluded from PDC and receipt selection.

> **Post invoices in the period they belong to**
>
> The journal takes the **invoice date**, not the date you press Post. Posting a January invoice in March still dates the journal in January — which is correct, but means the January reports change after you post. Post promptly, and never post into a closed period.

CHAPTER 14

Customer Receipts

Accounts ▸ Customer Receipts · **Workflow step 7**

A customer receipt records money collected from a tenant against a specific invoice — cash, transfer, or a cheque you are banking directly. Cheques handled through the PDC register clear themselves and do **not** need a receipt.

14.1 Recording a receipt

1. Select **New Receipt**.
2. Choose the **Invoice** being paid. The outstanding balance is displayed.
3. Enter the **Receipt Number** — unique within the company.
4. Enter the **Receipt Date** — the date the money was actually received.
5. Enter the **Amount**. Part payments are allowed.
6. Record the **Payment Method** and any **Reference** (transfer reference, cheque number).
7. **Save**. The journal posts immediately.

Account	Debit	Credit
`11100` Cash and Cash Equivalents	Amount	—
`11200` Accounts Receivable	—	Amount

14.2 Effect on the invoice

The receipt adds to the invoice's *Amount Paid* and re-evaluates its status: below the total it becomes **PartiallyPaid**; equal to the total it becomes **Paid**.

> **One receipt, one invoice**
>
> Each receipt settles a single invoice. If a tenant pays one amount covering three invoices, enter three receipts with the same date and reference, splitting the amount across the invoices. This keeps the tenant statement accurate at invoice level.

CHAPTER 15

Security Deposits

Accounts ▸ Security Deposits

A security deposit is money you hold on the tenant's behalf and expect to return at the end of the lease. It is never income. The system records it as a liability from the moment it is received.

15.1 Recording a deposit

1. Select **New Security Deposit**.
2. Choose the **Lease**.
3. Enter the **Reference Number** and the **Receipt Date**.
4. Enter the **Amount** — normally the deposit agreed on the lease.
5. **Save**.

Account	Debit	Credit
`11100` Cash and Cash Equivalents	Amount	—
`21300` Tenant Security Deposits	—	Amount

> **Never treat a deposit as rent**
> Recording a deposit as a customer receipt would reduce the tenant's receivable and eventually show as revenue. Always use the Security Deposits screen. At the end of the lease, refund or forfeit the deposit with a manual journal (Chapter 21) that debits `21300`.

15.2 Releasing a deposit at lease end

Situation	Manual journal to post
Refunded in full	Dr `21300` Tenant Security Deposits · Cr `11100` Cash
Forfeited to cover damages	Dr `21300` Tenant Security Deposits · Cr `43100` Other Income
Applied against unpaid rent	Dr `21300` Tenant Security Deposits · Cr `11200` Accounts Receivable

CHAPTER 16

Revenue Recognition

Setup ▸ Revenue Recognition

This screen turns billed rent into earned revenue, one month at a time. It is the mechanism that keeps the Profit & Loss faithful to the period rather than to the billing cycle.

16.1 How the schedule is built

When a lease is saved, one planned entry is created for the last day of every month in the lease term, each for one-twelfth of the annual rent. Every entry starts with status **Planned**.

16.2 Running the recognition

1. Open **Setup ▸ Revenue Recognition**. Planned and posted entries are listed.
2. Enter the **cut-off date** — normally the last day of the month you are closing.
3. Select **Process**. Every planned entry dated on or before the cut-off is posted, oldest first.
4. Their status changes to **Posted** and each links to its journal.

Owned property

Account	Debit	Credit
`21200` Advances from Customers	Monthly amount	—
`41100` Rental Revenue – Owned	—	Monthly amount

Managed property

Account	Debit	Credit
`21500` Due to Landlords	Monthly amount	—
`42100` Management Fee Revenue	—	Monthly amount

> **Make this the first task of every month-end**
> Run revenue recognition before printing the Profit & Loss. If you skip it, revenue for the month is missing and the deferred-income balance is overstated by the same amount. Running it late is safe: each entry keeps its own month-end date, so the figures land in the correct period.

16.3 Reading the deferred balance

At any date, the balance on `21200` Advances from Customers is the rent you have billed but not yet earned. It should equal the sum of all planned (unposted) recognition entries for invoices already posted. This is a useful monthly reconciliation.

CHAPTER 17

Vendor Bills

Accounts ▸ Vendor Bills

A vendor bill records an expense you have incurred and the obligation to pay for it.

17.1 Entering a bill

1. Select **New Bill**.
2. Choose the **Vendor**.
3. Choose the **Property** the cost relates to, if any. This drives property-level cost reporting.
4. Enter the **Bill Number** (the vendor's own reference) and the **Bill Date**.
5. Choose the **Expense Category**. This determines the expense account used.
6. Enter the **Subtotal** and the **VAT Amount** where recoverable.
7. **Save**, then **Post**.

Account	Debit	Credit
Expense account for the category (e.g. `52100` Property Maintenance)	Subtotal	—
`11300` VAT Recoverable (only if VAT > 0)	VAT	—
`21100` Accounts Payable	—	Total

> **Expense category drives the account**
>
> Categories resolve to a specific expense account, falling back to `51100` Property Operating Expenses for direct costs and `61100` Administrative Expenses for general costs. If a cost is landing in the wrong account, the category is the field to correct.

CHAPTER 18

Vendor Payments

Accounts ▸ Vendor Payments

18.1 Paying a bill

1. Select **New Payment**.
2. Choose the **Vendor Bill** being paid. The outstanding balance is displayed.
3. Enter the **Payment Number** and the **Payment Date**.
4. Enter the **Amount**. Part payments are allowed.
5. Record the **Payment Method** and any **Reference**.
6. **Save**. The journal posts immediately.

Account	Debit	Credit
`21100` Accounts Payable	Amount	—
`11100` Cash and Cash Equivalents	—	Amount

The bill's *Amount Paid* increases and its status advances to **PartiallyPaid** or **Paid** in the same way as customer invoices.

CHAPTER 19

Fixed Assets & Depreciation

Accounts ▸ Fixed Assets

The fixed asset register tracks long-lived items — lifts, generators, air-conditioning plant, vehicles, fit-out — from acquisition through capitalisation to monthly depreciation.

19.1 Creating an asset

1. Select **New Fixed Asset**.
2. Enter the **Asset Code** and **Name**.
3. Select the **Asset Account** and the **Accumulated Depreciation Account** (defaults `15200` and `15300`).
4. Enter the **Useful Life (months)** and the **Depreciation Start Date**.
5. For assets migrated from a previous system, enter the **Opening Cost** and **Opening Accumulated Depreciation**.
6. **Save**.

19.2 Acquisition costs

Open an asset and select **Acquisition** to accumulate the costs that make up its value — the supplier invoice, freight, installation, professional fees. Each entry posts:

Account	Debit	Credit
`15400` Fixed Asset Clearing (capitalisable) or the expense account (not capitalisable)	Amount	—
Offset account — `11100` Cash or `21100` Accounts Payable	—	Amount

Choosing a vendor with an Accounts Payable offset also raises the vendor bill automatically, so the payable appears in the vendor's sub-ledger.

19.3 Capitalisation

When the asset is complete and in use, capitalise it. The accumulated clearing balance moves to the asset account and the depreciation schedule is generated over the useful life:

Account	Debit	Credit
`15200` Fixed Assets	Capitalised cost	—
`15400` Fixed Asset Clearing	—	Capitalised cost

19.4 Running depreciation

1. Open **Depreciation** from the fixed asset screen.
2. Enter the **posting date** — normally the month end being closed.

3. Select **Post Depreciation**. Every scheduled instalment on or before that date is posted.

Account	Debit	Credit
`62100` Depreciation Expense	Monthly charge	—
`15300` Accumulated Depreciation	—	Monthly charge

> **Accumulated Depreciation presentation**
> In this chart of accounts, `15300` is classified as an asset and carries a credit balance, acting as a contra-asset. It therefore reduces Total Assets on the Balance Sheet, which is the correct presentation. Do not "correct" its sign.

CHAPTER 20

Recurring Prepayments

Setup ▸ Recurring Prepayments

Use a prepayment schedule when you pay once for something consumed over many months — annual insurance, a trade licence, a maintenance contract. The cost is parked on the balance sheet and released to the Profit & Loss evenly.

20.1 Creating a schedule

1. Select **New Prepayment**.
2. Enter a **Description** and choose the **Prepayment Type**.
3. Enter the **Payment Date** and the **Total Amount**.
4. Enter the **First Recognition Date** (normalised to a month end) and the **Recognition Months**.
5. Choose the **Prepaid Account** (default `11500`) and the **Expense Account** the cost belongs in.
6. Choose the **Offset Account** — cash if you paid directly, or Accounts Payable with a **Vendor** if it is on credit.
7. **Save**.

The setup journal posts immediately:

Account	Debit	Credit
`11500` Prepaid Expenses	Total amount	—
Offset — `11100` Cash or `21100` Accounts Payable	—	Total amount

20.2 Monthly amortisation

Each month end, process the schedule to release one instalment:

Account	Debit	Credit
Expense account chosen on the schedule	Monthly amount	—
`11500` Prepaid Expenses	—	Monthly amount

When the final instalment posts, the schedule is marked **Completed** and the prepaid balance for it is nil.

CHAPTER 21

Manual Journals

Accounts ▸ Manual Journals

Manual journals cover what the automatic postings cannot: accruals, corrections, deposit refunds, bank charges, reclassifications, and opening entries that do not belong to a sub-ledger.

21.1 Creating a journal

1. Select **New Manual Journal**.
2. Enter the **Entry Date** — the accounting date, which is the date the reports will use.
3. Enter a clear **Description** explaining why the entry exists.
4. Enter the **Document Number** and **Reference Number** where relevant.
5. For each line: choose the **Account**, enter either a **Debit** or a **Credit** (never both), and add a line **Description**.
6. Add lines until total debits equal total credits. The running totals are displayed as you type.
7. **Save**.

> **The balance rule is absolute**
> The system will not save a journal whose debits do not equal its credits, and will not accept a journal with fewer than two lines. If you see "*Journal entry is not balanced*", check for a line with an amount in both columns, or a typing error in one figure.

21.2 Common manual journals

Purpose	Entry
Refund a security deposit	Dr `21300` Tenant Security Deposits · Cr `11100` Cash
Bank charges	Dr `63100` Finance Costs · Cr `11100` Cash
Accrue an unbilled expense	Dr expense account · Cr `21100` Accounts Payable
Write off an irrecoverable receivable	Dr `61100` Administrative Expenses · Cr `11200` Accounts Receivable
Settle VAT with the authority	Dr `21400` VAT Payable · Cr `11300` VAT Recoverable and/or `11100` Cash
Pay a landlord their share	Dr `21500` Due to Landlords · Cr `11100` Cash
Owner takes money for personal use	Dr `34100` Owner's Current Account *with a withdrawal category* · Cr `11100` Cash — see Chapter 29

> **Write the narration for someone else**
> Six months from now, an auditor will read the description without any of today's context. Write it so that it explains itself: "*Refund of security deposit, lease LSE-0042, tenant Al Noor Trading, cheque 100233*", not "*deposit refund*".

CHAPTER 22

Journal Inquiry

Accounts ▸ Journal Inquiry

Journal Inquiry is the audit trail. Every journal in the company — automatic or manual — is listed here with its entry number, date, description, source type, source document and total value.

22.1 Investigating a figure

1. Filter by **date range**, **account**, **source type** or **document number**.
2. Open an entry to see all of its lines with their debits, credits and analytical tags.
3. Every line carries the property, unit, tenant, lease, vendor and source document it came from — so you can always trace a general ledger amount back to the operational transaction that caused it.

Source type	Created by
`CustomerInvoice`	Posting a customer invoice
`CustomerReceipt`	Recording a customer receipt
`PdcReceipt` / `PdcClearance`	Receiving and clearing a PDC
`SecurityDeposit`	Recording a security deposit
`RevenueRecognitionSchedule`	Processing revenue recognition
`VendorBill` / `VendorPayment`	Posting a bill or a payment
`FixedAsset…`	Acquisition, capitalisation, depreciation
`PrepaymentSchedule` / `PrepaymentRecognition`	Prepayment setup and amortisation
`Manual`	A manual journal
`FiscalYearClosing`	Closing the fiscal year

CHAPTER 23

Period & Year Closing

Setup ▸ Closing

Closing locks a period so that its reported figures cannot change afterwards. The screen shows the twelve monthly periods of the selected fiscal year with their status, and the history of fiscal years already closed.

23.1 Month-end checklist

1. Post every customer invoice dated in the month.
2. Record every customer receipt and clear every PDC that the bank honoured.
3. Post every vendor bill and vendor payment.
4. Run **Revenue Recognition** to the month-end date.
5. Run **Depreciation** to the month-end date.
6. Process **Prepayment** amortisation for the month.
7. Post any accruals or adjustments as manual journals.
8. Run the **Trial Balance** and confirm debits equal credits.
9. Review the **Profit & Loss** and **Balance Sheet**.
10. Return to **Setup** ▸ **Closing** and **Close Period**.

23.2 Closing the fiscal year

After the final period of the year is closed and reviewed, use **Close Year**. The system posts a closing journal that transfers the net result of every revenue and expense account into equity:

Account	Debit	Credit
Each revenue account (cleared to nil)	Balance	—
Each expense account (cleared to nil)	—	Balance
`32100` Retained Earnings – Prior Years	Net loss	Net profit

The closing is recorded with its fiscal year, the profit or loss amount, the timestamp and a link to the journal, so it is fully auditable.

> **Close each year before reporting on the next**
>
> The Balance Sheet presents the current fiscal year's profit as a separate equity line and takes prior years from Retained Earnings. If a year is never closed, its profit stays in the revenue and expense accounts — which the Balance Sheet does not present — and the Balance Sheet will not balance once you cross into the following year.

CHAPTER 24

Trial Balance

Reports ▸ Trial Balance

The Trial Balance lists every account with a balance as at a chosen date and proves that the ledger is internally consistent. It is the first report to run and the last one to check.

24.1 Running the report

1. Enter the **As Of Date**.
2. Select **Refresh**.

The report is **cumulative**: it includes every posted journal from the beginning of the ledger up to and including the as-of date, plus opening balances. That is the correct behaviour for a trial balance — it shows a position, not a movement. To see movement between two dates, use the **General Ledger** report (Chapter 27), which shows opening balance, period debits, period credits and closing balance per account.

24.2 Columns

Column	Meaning
Code / Account	The account, sorted by code.
Type	Asset, Liability, Equity, Revenue or Expense.
Debit	Shown when the account's net balance is on the debit side.
Credit	Shown when the account's net balance is on the credit side.

Each account appears once, with its net balance on one side only. Accounts with a nil balance are omitted.

> **Totals must be equal**
>
> Total Debit must equal Total Credit. Because the system refuses to post an unbalanced journal, any difference comes from opening balances, not from transactions. Go to **Setup** ▸ **Opening Balances** and check the Net Imbalance card — the difference on the Trial Balance will match it exactly. Appendix D walks through the diagnosis.

CHAPTER 25

Profit & Loss

Reports ▸ Profit & Loss

The Profit & Loss reports performance **over a period**: revenue earned less expenses incurred between two dates.

25.1 Running the report

1. Enter the **As Of Date** — the end of the period you want.
2. Select **Refresh**. The report covers **1 January of that year to the as-of date**.

25.2 What it contains

Section	Contents
Revenue	Every revenue account with a movement in the period, shown as credits less debits. Includes rental revenue released by revenue recognition, management fees and other income.
Expenses	Every expense account with a movement, shown as debits less credits. Direct property costs, administrative costs, depreciation, finance costs.
Net Profit / Loss	Total revenue less total expenses. This is the figure the Balance Sheet shows as Current Year Profit / Loss.

> **Revenue appears only after recognition**
>
> Invoicing a tenant does not create revenue. If the Profit & Loss shows less rent than you expect, the usual reason is that revenue recognition has not been processed up to the report date. Run **Setup ▸ Revenue Recognition** and refresh.

> **Non-calendar fiscal years**
>
> The report currently starts the period at 1 January of the as-of year. If your company's fiscal year starts in another month, the Profit & Loss period and the Balance Sheet's Current Year Profit / Loss will not agree. In that case, read the year-to-date result from the Balance Sheet, which follows the company's configured fiscal year start.
>
> The **Profit & Loss by Property** report (Chapter 28) does not have this limitation: it takes an explicit From and To date and defaults to the company's configured fiscal year. Use it when you need a period other than calendar year to date.

25.3 Analysing the result by property

This report presents the company as a whole. To see the same revenue and expenses broken down per property, use **Reports ▸ P&L by Property** — see Chapter 28.

CHAPTER 26

Balance Sheet

Reports ▸ Balance Sheet

The Balance Sheet reports financial position **at a single date**: what the company owns, what it owes, and the residual belonging to the owners.

26.1 Running the report

1. Enter the **As Of Date**.
2. Select **Refresh**.

26.2 Structure

Section	Contents
Assets	Cash, receivables, VAT recoverable, PDCs on hand, prepaid expenses, investment property, fixed assets net of accumulated depreciation.
Liabilities	Payables, advances from customers (deferred rent), security deposits held, VAT payable, amounts due to landlords, PDC contra.
Equity	Share Capital, Retained Earnings – Prior Years, any other equity accounts, and **Current Year Profit / Loss** computed from the fiscal-year-to-date Profit & Loss.

26.3 The balancing check

Total Assets must equal **Total Liabilities and Equity**. If they differ, the cause is almost always one of:

- **Unbalanced opening balances.** Check **Setup** ▸ **Opening Balances**; the difference will match the Net Imbalance exactly.
- **An unclosed prior fiscal year.** Prior-year profit remains in revenue and expense accounts, which the Balance Sheet does not present. Close the year (Chapter 23).

> **Cross-check against the Trial Balance**
>
> Trial Balance total debit minus total credit equals Total Assets minus Total Liabilities and Equity. The two reports fail together and are fixed together — you never have to diagnose them separately.

CHAPTER 27

General Ledger & Tenant Statement

27.1 General Ledger

Reports ▸ General Ledger

The General Ledger shows the detailed movement of a single account between two dates. This is the report to use when you need *activity for a period* rather than a position at a date.

1. Choose the **Account**.
2. Enter the **From Date** and **To Date**.
3. Select **Refresh**.

The report presents the **opening balance** at the from-date, then every journal line in the period with its date, entry number, description and debit or credit, with a **running balance**, and finally the **closing balance** and period totals.

> **Use this to explain any Trial Balance figure**
> If an account's Trial Balance figure looks wrong, run the General Ledger for that account across the full period. Every posting that produced the balance is listed, each traceable to its source document through Journal Inquiry.

27.2 Tenant Statement

Reports ▸ Tenant Statement

A tenant-facing account showing everything charged to and received from one tenant.

1. Choose the **Tenant**.
2. Enter the date range.
3. Select **Refresh**, then print or save to PDF for the tenant.

The statement shows the tenant's opening balance, each invoice as a charge and each receipt or cleared PDC as a credit in date order with a running balance, then total charges, total payments and the closing balance owed.

CHAPTER 28

Management Reports

The three reports in this chapter answer management questions rather than accounting questions: *which property is making money*, *how hard is the portfolio working*, and *which tenants can we rely on*. They are listed under **Reports** ▸ **Management Reports** and require the **View Reports** permission.

28.1 Profit & Loss by Property

Reports ▸ **P&L by Property**

This is the general ledger Profit & Loss analysed across the **property dimension** that every journal line already carries. Accounts run down the rows, properties across the columns, so you can read one property's result down a column or one account across the whole portfolio along a row.

1. Enter the **From Date** and **To Date**. The default is the current fiscal year to date, honouring the company's fiscal year start month.
2. Optionally choose a single **Property** to narrow the report to one column.
3. Select **Refresh**.

Each column shows total revenue, total expenses, net profit or loss and net margin percentage. The final column totals the row across all properties and reconciles to the general ledger Profit & Loss for the same dates.

> **The Unallocated column**
>
> A journal line only carries a property if the source transaction identified one. Invoices, receipts, PDCs, revenue recognition and security deposits always do, because they descend from a lease. Vendor bills do when a property is chosen on the bill. **Manual journals only do when a unit / cost centre is selected on the line** — the property is then derived from that unit.
>
> Anything without a property is collected into a highlighted **Unallocated** column so the report still reconciles to the GL. If that column is large, the fix is to reopen those manual journals and set the unit.

Revenue is presented as credits less debits and expenses as debits less credits, so a negative figure means a reversal or reclassification occurred in the period rather than an error.

28.2 Property Utilization

Reports ▸ **Property Utilization**

A single-page view of how hard each property is working at a chosen date.

Measure	How it is calculated
Occupancy %	Units with status *Occupied* ÷ total units. Driven by unit status, which is set automatically when a lease becomes active.
Area utilization %	Area of units under a lease that is active and current at the as-of date ÷ total area. Measures let space rather than unit count, so one large vacant unit shows its true weight.
Standard annual rent	Sum of each unit's asking rent.
Contracted annual rent	Sum of the annual rent on leases active at the as-of date.
Rent realisation %	Contracted ÷ standard. Below 100% means vacancy or leases signed under the asking rent; above 100% means units are let above asking.
Rent gap	Standard less contracted — annualised revenue being forgone. The number to attack first.
Rent per sq ft	Contracted rent ÷ leased area. Compares pricing across properties of different sizes.
Expiring 90d	Active leases ending within 90 days of the as-of date — the renewal pipeline.

Summary cards at the top give the portfolio position, and a total row closes the table. Occupancy and area utilization each carry a colour bar: green at 85% and above, amber from 60%, red below.

> **Occupancy and area utilization can disagree — and that is useful**
> High unit occupancy with low area utilization means your small units are let and your large ones are empty. That single comparison usually points straight at where the revenue is being lost.

28.3 Tenant Health & Ranking

Reports ▸ Tenant Health & Ranking

Every tenant scored from 0 to 100 and ranked best first, with the underlying figures shown alongside the score so the ranking can always be explained to the tenant or to management.

The four components

Component	Weight	Basis
Collection ratio	40%	Total collected ÷ total invoiced. The strongest single signal of a paying tenant. Collections include cleared PDCs, because clearance updates the invoice.
Overdue exposure	30%	Overdue balance ÷ total invoiced, inverted, then reduced by an ageing penalty of up to 30 points as the oldest overdue invoice passes 120 days.
PDC reliability	15%	Cleared cheque value ÷ (cleared + bounced) value.
Tenure & commitment	15%	Years occupied since the first lease start, capped at five years (70% of the component), plus current contract length capped at 36 months (30%).

Missing data never counts against a tenant

A component that cannot be measured — a tenant who has never issued a post-dated cheque, or one with no invoices yet — is dropped, and its weight is shared across the components that can be measured. Nobody is penalised for the absence of a behaviour rather than for the behaviour itself. A tenant with no measurable activity at all is shown as *No activity* and graded N/A.

Grades

Grade	Score	Reading
A	85 – 100	Pays in full and on time, long tenure. Prioritise renewal.
B	70 – 84	Reliable with minor slippage.
C	55 – 69	Watch list. Follow up before the next billing date.
D	40 – 54	Material arrears or a short, unproven relationship. Secure additional cover.
E	Below 40	Serious exposure. Check deposit cover and consider legal steps.

Columns worth knowing

- **Outstanding** includes the tenant's opening balance, so it agrees with the tenant statement.
- **Overdue** counts only posted invoices past their due date and not fully paid. Draft and cancelled invoices are excluded because they carry no ledger balance.
- **Oldest (days)** is the age of the earliest unpaid overdue invoice — often more telling than the amount.
- **Avg days to pay** is the average of receipt date less invoice due date. A negative figure means the tenant pays early.
- **PDC on hand** is cheque value held but not yet cleared — future cash, not yet collected.
- **Deposit held** is the security deposit still in *Held* status, i.e. your cover against the arrears in the same row.
- **Tenure (yrs)** runs from the tenant's earliest lease start date to the as-of date, across all their contracts.

PDC reliability needs a bounce workflow to discriminate

The PDC register supports a *Bounced* status, but no screen currently sets it — a cheque is either *Received* or *Cleared*. Until a bounce action exists, the PDC reliability component scores 100% for every tenant who has had a cheque clear, and therefore does not yet separate good payers from bad ones. The other three components carry the ranking in the meantime.

CHAPTER 29

Owner Withdrawals

Money the owner takes out of the business for personal use is not a company expense. It is a **distribution** — a movement in equity. Putting it through the company's expense accounts would understate profit and misstate the Profit & Loss.

But the owner still wants to know what they spent it on. RealEstateManager solves this with a dedicated analysis dimension: the posting goes to a single equity account, and each line carries an **owner withdrawal category** that says what the money was for.

> **Why this is not a chart-of-accounts problem**
>
> Adding expense accounts for "school fees" or "personal travel" would put the owner's private life into the company's books and inflate its cost base. Adding them as unit cost centres would be worse still — cost centres in this system are *units*, used to allocate rental revenue and property costs to the space that generated them. Owner spending relates to no unit at all.
>
> A separate dimension keeps the chart of accounts clean, keeps cost centres meaningful, and still gives the owner a full breakdown.

29.1 The owner's current account

The standard chart seeds one equity account for this purpose:

Code	Account	Type
`34100`	Owner's Current Account	Equity, flagged as an owner account

Because it is equity, a **credit** balance means the business owes the owner, and a **withdrawal is a debit** that reduces that balance. Capital the owner puts in is a credit.

If you have more than one owner, add one account per owner — `34200`, `34300` and so on — under **Setup ▸ Chart of Accounts**, setting **Owner Account** to *Yes* on each. The same category list serves all of them, and each gets its own column in the report. Only a postable Equity account can be flagged this way; the setting is ignored on any other type.

29.2 Maintaining the categories

Setup ▸ Owner Withdrawal Categories

A starter set is created for every company and can be renamed, reordered, deactivated or replaced entirely:

Code	Category	Typical use
`OW-10`	Cash Drawings	Cash taken for personal use
`OW-20`	Household & Living	Groceries, utilities, household running costs
`OW-30`	Education	School and university fees
`OW-40`	Travel	Personal travel and accommodation
`OW-50`	Vehicles	Personal vehicles, servicing, fuel
`OW-60`	Medical & Insurance	Personal medical and insurance
`OW-70`	Charity & Donations	Personal giving
`OW-80`	Personal Investments	Funds moved to private investments
`OW-99`	Other Personal	Anything that fits nowhere else

1. Select **New Category**.
2. Enter a unique **Code** and a **Name**.
3. Add a **Description** so other users apply it consistently.
4. Set the **Sort Order** to control where it appears in the selector and the report.
5. **Save**.

The list screen shows, for each category, how many posted journal lines use it and the net amount posted against it — so you can see at a glance which categories are actually being used.

> **Deactivate rather than delete**
> A category already used by a posted journal cannot be removed, because those journals reference it. Untick **Active** instead: it disappears from the General Journal selector while every journal already posted against it, and every historical report, stays exactly as it was.

29.3 Posting owner expenditure

Accounts ▸ Manual Journals ▸ New Manual Journal

The General Journal has an **Owner Withdrawal Category** column. It activates only on a line posted to an account flagged as an owner account; on every other line it stays locked and empty, and the row is highlighted when the dimension becomes available.

1. Enter the **Entry Date** and a clear **Description**.
2. On the first line choose the **owner's current account** and enter the amount as a **Debit**.
3. Choose the **Owner Withdrawal Category** — the column is now enabled on that line.
4. On the second line credit whatever the money came out of, normally `11100` Cash and Cash Equivalents.
5. **Save and Post**.

Owner pays school fees of 25,000 from the company bank account

Account	Category	Debit	Credit
`34100` Owner's Current Account	OW-30 Education	25,000.00	—
`11100` Cash and Cash Equivalents	—	—	25,000.00

No expense account is touched, so company profit is unaffected. The owner's equity balance falls by 25,000 and the spend is tagged as Education.

Owner introduces 100,000 of capital

Account	Category	Debit	Credit
`11100` Cash and Cash Equivalents	—	100,000.00	—
`34100` Owner's Current Account	leave blank	—	100,000.00

Leave the category blank on money coming *in*. Categories describe expenditure; a contribution is not expenditure.

> **The category is refused on any other account**
>
> If you try to save a category against an account that is not flagged as an owner account, the journal is rejected with a message naming the offending account. This is enforced on the server, not just hidden in the screen — it is what guarantees personal spending can never reach a company account by accident.

29.4 The Owner Withdrawals report

Reports ▸ Owner Withdrawals

Enter a **From** and **To** date — the default is the company's fiscal year to date. The report has three parts:

- **Owner Account Movement** — per owner account: opening balance, withdrawals in the period, contributions in the period, and closing balance.
- **Breakdown by Category** — categories down the rows, owner accounts across the columns, with each category's share of total spend.
- **Detail** — every line posted to an owner account in the period, with its date, entry number, description and category.

Reading	Meaning
Credit closing balance	The business still owes the owner this amount.
Debit closing balance	The owner has drawn more than they put in and now owes the business.
Negative category amount	A refund of personal spend back into the business, posted against that category.
Uncategorised row	Movement with no category. Expected for capital introduced or a transfer of the owner's balance; investigate if it represents spending.

> **What this gives you that other systems do not**
>
> The owner gets a full personal expenditure statement, and the company's Profit & Loss stays a true record of trading. Both come from the same posted journal — there is no separate spreadsheet to reconcile, and no risk of personal spend leaking into the company's cost base.

29.5 Clearing the balance at year end

The owner's current account carries forward like any equity account. If you want to clear it against retained earnings — for example when drawings are formally treated as a distribution of profit — post a manual journal debiting `32100` Retained Earnings – Prior Years and crediting `34100` Owner's Current Account. Leave the category blank: it is a transfer, not expenditure.

CHAPTER 30

Companies, Users & Permissions

28.1 Companies

Setup ▸ **Companies** — system administrators only.

Each company is a completely separate set of books with its own chart of accounts, master data and ledger. Creating a company automatically seeds its chart of accounts, its account mapping and its monthly accounting periods.

Field	Meaning
Name	Appears in the company selector and on reports.
Base Currency	Reporting currency, e.g. AED.
Fiscal Year Start Month	1 for a January–December year. Drives accounting periods and the Balance Sheet's current-year profit calculation.

28.2 Users

Setup ▸ **Users** — system administrators only.

1. Select **New User**.
2. Enter the **Username**, **Display Name** and an initial **Password**.
3. Grant access to one or more **Companies**.
4. Tick the **Permissions** the user needs.
5. **Save** and give the user their credentials. They should change the password at first login.

28.3 The four permissions

Permission	Group	Grants access to
Manage Master Data	Operations	Properties, Units, Tenants, Vendors
Manage Leases	Operations	Lease contracts and related operations
Manage Accounting	Accounting	Invoices, receipts, PDCs, payables, security deposits, fixed assets, prepayments, revenue recognition, journals, chart of accounts, account mapping, opening balances, closing
View Reports	Reporting	Trial Balance, Profit & Loss, Balance Sheet, General Ledger, Tenant Statement

28.4 Suggested role profiles

Role	Permissions
Leasing officer	Manage Master Data · Manage Leases
Accountant	Manage Accounting · View Reports
Finance manager	Manage Accounting · View Reports · Manage Master Data
Owner / auditor	View Reports only
Administrator	All four, plus the SystemAdmin role for Companies, Users and Audit Logs

> **Permissions are enforced at the server**
>
> Hiding a menu is not the control — the server independently refuses any request the user is not entitled to make. Typing a URL directly will not bypass a permission.

CHAPTER 31

Subscription, Audit Log & Feedback

29.1 Subscription

Setup ▸ Subscription

Shows the company's current subscription state, its expiry date and the days remaining. New companies start on a 15-day trial. To extend, enter the activation code supplied by your provider and select **Activate**. When a subscription expires, processing menus are withdrawn until it is renewed; no data is lost.

29.2 Audit Logs

Setup ▸ Audit Logs — system administrators only.

Records who did what and when across the application. Filter by user, date range, action or entity to investigate a change. Combined with Journal Inquiry, this gives a complete evidence trail: the audit log shows the user action, the journal shows its accounting consequence.

29.3 Help

Setup ▸ Help

A built-in quick guide covering the main workflows, with links to this manual and to the interactive Workflow screen.

29.4 Feedback

Setup ▸ Feedback

Submit a problem report or an improvement request. Include the screen name, what you did, what you expected and what happened, plus any document number involved — that is usually enough to resolve an issue without further correspondence. Administrators review submissions under **Setup ▸ Feedback Review**.

APPENDIX A

Chart of Accounts Reference

The standard chart created for every new company. Group accounts are shown in bold and cannot be posted to.

Code	Account	Type	Reporting group
10000	**Assets**	Asset	Assets
11100	Cash and Cash Equivalents	Asset	Assets
11200	Accounts Receivable (control)	Asset	Assets
11300	VAT Recoverable	Asset	Assets
11400	PDC On Hand	Asset	Assets
11500	Prepaid Expenses	Asset	Assets
15100	Investment Property	Asset	Assets
15200	Fixed Assets	Asset	Assets
15300	Accumulated Depreciation (contra)	Asset	Assets
15400	Fixed Asset Clearing	Asset	Assets
20000	**Liabilities**	Liability	Liabilities
21100	Accounts Payable (control)	Liability	Liabilities
21200	Advances from Customers (unearned revenue)	Liability	Liabilities
21300	Tenant Security Deposits	Liability	Liabilities
21400	VAT Payable	Liability	Liabilities
21500	Due to Landlords	Liability	Liabilities
21600	PDC Contra	Liability	Liabilities
30000	**Equity**	Equity	Equity
31100	Share Capital	Equity	Equity
32100	Retained Earnings – Prior Years	Equity	Equity
33100	Current Year Profit or Loss	Equity	Equity
34100	Owner's Current Account (owner account)	Equity	Equity
40000	**Revenue**	Revenue	Revenue
41100	Rental Revenue – Owned	Revenue	Revenue
42100	Management Fee Revenue	Revenue	Revenue
43100	Other Income	Revenue	Revenue
50000	**Direct Expenses**	Expense	DirectExpense
51100	Property Operating Expenses	Expense	DirectExpense
52100	Property Maintenance	Expense	DirectExpense
60000	**General Expenses**	Expense	GeneralExpense
61100	Administrative Expenses	Expense	GeneralExpense
62100	Depreciation Expense	Expense	GeneralExpense
63100	Finance Costs	Expense	GeneralExpense

APPENDIX B

Accounting Entries Reference

Every journal the system posts automatically. All are generated with balanced debits and credits; the system rejects any entry that does not balance.

Transaction	Debit	Credit
Customer invoice owned property	11200 Accounts Receivable — total	21200 Advances from Customers — subtotal 21400 VAT Payable — VAT
Customer invoice managed property	11200 Accounts Receivable — total	21500 Due to Landlords — subtotal 21400 VAT Payable — VAT
Customer receipt	11100 Cash and Cash Equivalents	11200 Accounts Receivable
PDC received memorandum	11400 PDC On Hand	21600 PDC Contra
PDC cleared receivable mode	21600 PDC Contra (reversal) 11100 Cash and Cash Equivalents	11400 PDC On Hand (reversal) 11200 Accounts Receivable
PDC cleared advance mode	21600 PDC Contra (reversal) 11100 Cash and Cash Equivalents	11400 PDC On Hand (reversal) 21200 Advances from Customers
Security deposit	11100 Cash and Cash Equivalents	21300 Tenant Security Deposits
Revenue recognition owned property	21200 Advances from Customers	41100 Rental Revenue – Owned
Revenue recognition managed property	21500 Due to Landlords	42100 Management Fee Revenue
Vendor bill	Expense account by category — subtotal 11300 VAT Recoverable — VAT	21100 Accounts Payable — total
Vendor payment	21100 Accounts Payable	11100 Cash and Cash Equivalents
Fixed asset acquisition cost	15400 Fixed Asset Clearing (capitalisable) or expense account (not capitalisable)	11100 Cash or 21100 Accounts Payable
Fixed asset capitalisation	15200 Fixed Assets	15400 Fixed Asset Clearing
Depreciation	62100 Depreciation Expense	15300 Accumulated Depreciation
Prepayment setup	11500 Prepaid Expenses	11100 Cash or 21100 Accounts Payable
Prepayment amortisation	Expense account on the schedule	11500 Prepaid Expenses
Fiscal year closing	Each revenue account — its balance 32100 Retained Earnings — if a net loss	Each expense account — its balance 32100 Retained Earnings — if a net profit

APPENDIX C

Status Values Reference

Record	Status	Meaning
Unit	Vacant	Available to lease.
	Occupied	Under an active lease. Set automatically.
	UnderMaintenance	Temporarily out of service.
	Reserved	Held for a prospective tenant.
Lease	Draft	Being prepared.
	Active	In force. Set on creation.
	Terminated	Ended early.
	Expired	Ran to its end date.
	Renewed	Replaced by a successor contract.
Customer invoice	Draft	Generated, not posted. No ledger impact.
	Posted	Journal written; fully outstanding.
	PartiallyPaid	Part settled.
	Paid	Fully settled.
	Cancelled	Voided.
PDC receipt	Draft	Transient state during creation.
	Received	In custody; memorandum posted.
	Cleared	Honoured by the bank; cash recorded.
Vendor bill	Draft	Entered, not posted.
	Posted	Journal written; payable outstanding.
	PartiallyPaid	Part settled.
	Paid	Fully settled.
Revenue recognition	Planned	Scheduled, not yet posted.
	Posted	Journal written; revenue earned.
Prepayment schedule	Active	Instalments still to release.
	Completed	Fully amortised.
Accounting period	Open	Accepts postings.
	Closed	Locked; figures are final.

APPENDIX D

Troubleshooting

D.1 The Trial Balance does not balance

Because the system rejects any unbalanced journal, transactions cannot cause this. The cause is opening balances.

1. Open **Setup ▸ Opening Balances**.
2. Read the **Net Imbalance (Dr − Cr)** card. It will equal the Trial Balance difference exactly.
3. Identify the missing side. Debits exceeding credits means a credit-side opening balance is missing — almost always equity.
4. Open **Setup ▸ Chart of Accounts**, edit `31100` Share Capital or `32100` Retained Earnings – Prior Years, and enter the balancing figure.
5. Return to Opening Balances and confirm the green **Balanced** badge, then re-run the Trial Balance.

> **Worked diagnosis**
> Trial Balance shows debits 375,000 and credits 175,000 — a difference of 200,000. The credit side contains only transaction balances, and Share Capital and Retained Earnings are both nil. The conclusion is that 200,000 of asset opening balances were entered with no matching equity opening balance. Entering 200,000 on `31100` or `32100` balances both the Trial Balance and the Balance Sheet.

D.2 The Balance Sheet does not balance

- Check opening balances as in D.1 — the same difference appears in both reports.
- Check that every prior fiscal year has been closed. Unclosed prior-year profit sits in revenue and expense accounts, which the Balance Sheet does not present.

D.3 Revenue is missing from the Profit & Loss

- Run **Setup ▸ Revenue Recognition** up to the report date. Invoicing alone does not create revenue.
- Confirm the invoices themselves are **Posted**, not still in Draft.
- For a managed property, remember only the commission is revenue — the rent belongs to the landlord.

D.4 A transaction will not post

Message	Cause and fix
"Journal entry is not balanced."	A manual journal line has an amount in both the debit and credit columns, or the totals differ. Correct the line.
"A journal entry must contain at least two lines."	Add the counterpart line.
"Account mapping for … is not configured."	Open **Setup** ▸ **Account Mapping** and select a valid, active account for that mapping.
"Contract number already exists."	Contract numbers are unique per company. Use a different one.
"This unit already has an overlapping active lease."	Terminate or adjust the existing lease first.
"Cheque number already exists."	Cheque numbers are unique per company. Check whether the PDC was already logged.
"PDC amount cannot exceed the outstanding invoice balance."	Reduce the amount, or split the cheque across invoices.
"Billing frequency must be 1, 2, 3, 4, 6, or 12."	Billing frequency must divide 12 exactly.

D.5 A menu is not visible

- Confirm the permission with your administrator (Chapter 30).
- Check that the company's subscription has not expired — expiry withdraws the processing menus.
- Confirm you are in the right company using the company selector.

D.6 A tenant's balance looks wrong

1. Run **Reports** ▸ **Tenant Statement** for the tenant across the full period.
2. Check for invoices still in Draft — they are not in the ledger.
3. Check for PDCs still in Received status — the cash has not arrived yet.
4. Check for a security deposit wrongly entered as a customer receipt.
5. Confirm the tenant's opening balance was entered on the tenant record, not on the AR account.

APPENDIX E

Glossary

Term	Meaning
Accrual basis	Recording income when it is earned and expenses when they are incurred, regardless of when cash moves. The basis this system uses.
Advances from Customers	Account `21200`. Rent billed but not yet earned. A liability, released to revenue month by month.
Control account	A GL account whose balance is the total of a sub-ledger — Accounts Receivable over tenants, Accounts Payable over vendors.
Double entry	Every transaction affects at least two accounts with equal debits and credits, so the ledger is always self-proving.
Due to Landlords	Account `21500`. Rent collected on a managed property that belongs to its owner.
Fiscal year	The company's twelve-month reporting year, starting in the configured fiscal year start month.
Managed property	A property you administer for a third-party owner. Only your commission is revenue.
Natural balance	The side an account normally sits on: debit for assets and expenses, credit for liabilities, equity and revenue.
Opening balance	A balance brought forward from a previous system at go-live.
Owned property	A property you own. The rent is your revenue.
PDC	Post-dated cheque — a cheque held today, payable on a future date.
Posting	Writing a document's journal into the general ledger. Before posting, a document has no accounting effect.
Revenue recognition	Releasing billed rent into revenue as the occupancy is provided, one month at a time.
Sub-ledger	A detailed register behind a control account — the tenant register, the vendor register, the fixed asset register.
Trial balance	A listing of every account balance at a date, proving total debits equal total credits.
Unearned revenue	See Advances from Customers.